

**Technical Charter (the “Charter”)
for
AGENTS.md a Series of LF Projects, LLC**

Adopted December 8, 2025

This Charter sets forth the responsibilities and procedures for technical contribution to, and oversight of, the AGENTS.md open source project, which has been established as AGENTS.md a Series of LF Projects, LLC (the “Project”). LF Projects, LLC (“LF Projects”) is a Delaware series limited liability company. All contributors (including those serving as maintainers, the lead core maintainer, and other technical positions) and other participants in the Project (collectively, “Collaborators”) must comply with the terms of this Charter.

1. Mission and Scope of the Project

- a. The mission of the Project is to develop a simple, open format for guiding AI coding agents.
- b. The scope of the Project includes collaborative development under the Project License (as defined herein) supporting the mission, including documentation, testing, integration and the creation of other artifacts that aid the development, deployment, operation or adoption of the open source project.

2. Technical Steering Committee

- a. The Project adopts a hierarchical technical governance structure:

- i. A community of Contributors who file issues, make pull requests, and contribute to the project.
 - ii. a set of Maintainers who drive specific modules, repositories, or functional areas of the project.
 - iii. a smaller group of Core Maintainers who drive the overall technical direction of the project.
 - iv. A Lead Core Maintainer, who acts as the catch-all technical decision maker when the Core Maintainers cannot reach consensus.
- b. Membership in technical governance structure, (including Maintainer, Core Maintainer, or Lead Core Maintainer) is held by individuals, not companies, and no seats are reserved for specific organizations.
- c. For purposes of this charter, the Technical Steering Committee (the “TSC”) consists of all Core Maintainers together with the Lead Core Maintainer. The TSC is responsible for all technical oversight of the Project.
- d. The TSC voting members are initially the Project’s Core Maintainers. At the inception of the project, the initial lists of Maintainers, Core Maintainers, and the initial Lead Core Maintainer will be set forth within the “CONTRIBUTING” file within the Project’s code repository. The TSC may choose an alternative approach for determining the voting members of the TSC, and any such alternative approach will be documented in the CONTRIBUTING file. Any meetings of the Technical Steering Committee are intended to be open to the public, and can be conducted electronically, via teleconference, or in person.
- e. TSC projects generally will involve Contributors, Maintainers, Core Maintainers and the Lead Core Maintainer. The TSC may adopt or modify roles so long as the roles are documented in the CONTRIBUTING file. Unless otherwise documented:
 - i. **Contributors** include anyone in the technical community that contributes code, documentation, specifications, tests, or other technical artifacts to the Project. ;
 - ii. **Maintainers** are Contributors who have the ability to modify (“commit”) source code, documentation or other technical artifacts in a project’s repository. Maintainers are encouraged to propose additional Maintainers when needed; and
 - iii. **Core Maintainers** are Maintainers who are expected to have a deep understanding of the Project’s codebase, format, and design principles and who are collectively responsible for the overall technical direction of the Project. Core Maintainers generally have administrative rights over the Project’s GitHub organization and repositories (subject to LF Projects

policies); and

- iv. The **Lead Core Maintainer** is one of the Core Maintainers, designated as the final technical decision maker when the Core Maintainers cannot reach consensus. The Lead Core Maintainer generally acts as TSC Chair for purposes of presiding over TSC meetings, unless the TSC designates another Core Maintainer to serve as Chair.
 - v. A Contributor may become a Maintainer by a majority approval of the TSC. A Maintainer may become a Core Maintainer by a majority approval of the TSC.
 - vi. A Maintainer may be removed by a majority approval of the TSC. A core Maintainer may be removed or confirmed by approval of the Lead Core Maintainer.
- f. Participation in the Project through becoming a Contributor and Maintainer is open to anyone so long as they abide by the terms of this Charter.
- g. The TSC may (1) establish work flow procedures for the submission, approval, and closure/archiving of projects, (2) set requirements for the promotion of Contributors to Maintainer, Core Maintainer, and Lead Maintainer as applicable, and (3) amend, adjust, refine and/or eliminate the roles of Contributors, and Maintainer, and create new roles, and publicly document any TSC roles, as it sees fit.
- h. Core Maintainer nomination and removal
- i. Any maintainer or Core Maintainer may nominate an individual (typically already a Maintainer) to become a Core Maintainer
 - ii. The Lead Core Maintainer is responsible for evaluating nominations for Core Maintainer status, taking into account statements of support from other Maintainers, Core Maintainers, and Community stakeholders, as well as the nominee's technical contributions and behavior.
 - iii. The Lead Core Maintainer will confirm or decline the nomination and will publicly articulate the reasoning for the decision.
 - iv. Proposals to remove a Core Maintainer may be raised by any Collaborator. The Core Maintainers (excluding any individual with a conflict of interest) will review relevant information (including activity levels, alignment with Project principles, and any Code of Conduct concerns) and will make and publicly document a decision.
- i. Lead Core Maintainer selection and removal

- i. A super-majority (at least seventy-five percent (75%)) of all Core Maintainers, excluding the current Lead Core Maintainer, voting in accordance with the TSC Voting section of this Charter, may vote to remove the Lead Core Maintainer.
 - ii. Following such removal, or in the event of permanent unavailability or resignation of the Lead Core Maintainer, the Core Maintainers will select a new Lead Core Maintainer using a ranked-choice or other consensus-seeking voting method documented in the CONTRIBUTING file. Any changes to Maintainer, Core Maintainer, or Lead Core Maintainer status will be promptly reflected in the CONTRIBUTING file or other publicly accessible Project documentation.
- j. The Lead Core Maintainer, or any other TSC member so designated by the TSC as the TSC Chair, will serve as the primary communication contact between the Project and Agentic AI Foundation (AAIF), a directed fund of The Linux Foundation.
- k. Responsibilities: The TSC will be responsible for all aspects of oversight relating to the Project, which may include:
 - i. coordinating the technical direction of the Project;
 - ii. approving project or system proposals (including, but not limited to, incubation, deprecation, and changes to a sub-project's scope);
 - iii. organizing sub-projects and removing sub-projects;
 - iv. creating sub-committees or working groups to focus on cross-project technical issues and requirements;
 - v. appointing representatives to work with other open source or open standards communities;
 - vi. establishing community norms, workflows, issuing releases, and security issue reporting policies;
 - vii. approving and implementing policies and processes for contributing (to be published in the CONTRIBUTING file) and coordinating with the series manager of the Project (as provided for in the Series Agreement, the "Series Manager") to resolve matters or concerns that may arise as set forth in Section 7 of this Charter;
 - viii. facilitating discussions, seeking consensus, and where necessary, voting on technical matters relating to the code base that affect multiple projects; and

- ix. coordinating any marketing, events, or communications regarding the Project.

3. TSC Voting

- a. While the Project aims to operate as a consensus-based community, if any TSC decision requires a vote to move the Project forward, the voting members of the TSC will vote on a one vote per voting member basis.
- b. Quorum for TSC meetings requires at least fifty percent of all voting members of the TSC to be present. The TSC may continue to meet if quorum is not met but will be prevented from making any decisions at the meeting.
- c. Except as provided in Section 7.c. and 8.a, decisions by vote at a meeting require a majority vote of those in attendance, provided quorum is met. Decisions made by electronic vote without a meeting require a majority vote of all voting members of the TSC.
- d. In the event a vote cannot be resolved by the TSC, any voting member of the TSC may refer the matter to the Series Manager for assistance in reaching a resolution.

4. Compliance with Policies

- a. This Charter is subject to the Series Agreement for the Project and the Operating Agreement of LF Projects. Contributors will comply with the policies of LF Projects as may be adopted and amended by LF Projects, including, without limitation the policies listed at <https://lfprojects.org/policies/>.
- b. The TSC may adopt a code of conduct (“CoC”) for the Project, which is subject to approval by the Series Manager. In the event that a Project-specific CoC has not been approved, the LF Projects Code of Conduct listed at <https://lfprojects.org/policies> will apply for all Collaborators in the Project.
- c. When amending or adopting any policy applicable to the Project, LF Projects will publish such policy, as to be amended or adopted, on its web site at least 30 days prior to such policy taking effect; provided, however, that in the case of any amendment of the Trademark Policy or Terms of Use of LF Projects, any such amendment is effective upon publication on LF Project’s web site.
- d. All Collaborators must allow open participation from any individual or organization meeting the requirements for contributing under this Charter and any policies adopted for all Collaborators by the TSC, regardless of competitive interests. Put another way, the Project community must not seek to exclude any participant based on any criteria, requirement, or reason other than those that are reasonable and applied on a non-discriminatory basis to all Collaborators in the Project community.

- e. The Project will operate in a transparent, open, collaborative, and ethical manner at all times. The output of all Project discussions, proposals, timelines, decisions, and status should be made open and easily visible to all. Any potential violations of this requirement should be reported immediately to the Series Manager.

5. Community Assets

- a. LF Projects (or an associated hosting entity) will hold title to all trade or service marks used by the Project (“Project Trademarks”), whether based on common law or registered rights. Project Trademarks will be transferred and assigned to LF Projects (or, where applicable, the associated hosting entity) to hold on behalf of the Project. Any use of any Project Trademarks by Collaborators in the Project will (a) either be (i) in a way that constitutes fair use or (ii) in accordance with the license from LF Projects to the Project and the applicable trademark usage guidelines and (b) inure to the benefit of LF Projects (or the associated hosting entity).
- b. The Project will, as permitted and in accordance with such license from LF Projects, develop and own all Project GitHub and social media accounts, and domain name registrations created by the Project community.
- c. Under no circumstances will LF Projects be expected or required to undertake any action on behalf of the Project that is inconsistent with the tax-exempt status or purpose, as applicable, of the Joint Development Foundation or LF Projects, LLC.

6. General Rules and Operations.

- a. The Project will:
 - i. engage in the work of the Project in a professional manner consistent with maintaining a cohesive community, while also maintaining the goodwill and esteem of LF Projects, Joint Development Foundation and other partner organizations in the open source community; and
 - ii. respect the rights of all trademark owners, including any branding and trademark usage guidelines.

7. Intellectual Property Policy

- a. Collaborators acknowledge that the copyright in all new contributions will be retained by the copyright holder as independent works of authorship and that no contributor or copyright holder will be required to assign copyrights to the Project.
- b. Except as described in Section 7.c., all contributions to the Project are subject to the following:

- i. All new inbound code contributions to the Project must be made using MIT License available at <https://opensource.org/licenses/MIT> (the “Project License”).
 - ii. All new inbound code contributions must also be accompanied by a Developer Certificate of Origin (<http://developercertificate.org>) sign-off in the source code system that is submitted through a TSC-approved contribution process which will bind the authorized contributor and, if not self-employed, their employer to the applicable license;
 - iii. All outbound code will be made available under the Project License.
 - iv. Documentation will be received and made available by the Project under the Creative Commons Attribution 4.0 International License (available at <http://creativecommons.org/licenses/by/4.0/>).
 - v. The Project may seek to integrate and contribute back to other open source projects (“Upstream Projects”). In such cases, the Project will conform to all license requirements of the Upstream Projects, including dependencies, leveraged by the Project. Upstream Project code contributions not stored within the Project’s main code repository will comply with the contribution process and license terms for the applicable Upstream Project.
- c. The TSC may approve the use of an alternative license or licenses for inbound or outbound contributions on an exception basis. To request an exception, please describe the contribution, the alternative open source license(s), and the justification for using an alternative open source license for the Project. License exceptions must be approved by a two-thirds vote of the entire TSC.
 - d. Contributed files should contain license information, such as SPDX short form identifiers, indicating the open source license or licenses pertaining to the file.

8. Amendments

- a. This charter may be amended by a two-thirds vote of the entire TSC and is subject to approval by LF Projects.